

Academic referencing

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Referencing is an important aspect of scientific writing. Many assignments and projects require students to reference their work. Some lose valuable marks for not performing this correctly or not adhering to the university standard for referencing. Some publishers will reject submissions due to incorrect referencing.

There are important reasons for citing the work of other researchers. In text referencing and bibliography serve different purposes in supporting the research. Different publishers and Universities apply different referencing styles. DUT uses the DUT/Harvard format. Managing citations and ensuring an accurate referencing and bibliography in the write-up is a difficult task. Therefore, the researcher has to make use of tools to support this task.

1. The importance of referencing

Referencing allows for the researcher to acknowledge the finished work and/or ideas of other researchers. Any written work be it an assignment or thesis that draws upon or derives from the work of another must reference the other work.

Using the published work or idea of another researcher without acknowledgement is plagiarism. This is a serious misdemeanour. Credit must be given to the existing works and ideas of others. This is a sign of academic respect of intellectual property which resulted from long duration of hard work. Citations are used to acknowledge the work of another.

Referencing is a way of showing engagement and sound understanding of the field of research. Readers will trace the references to the original publications that were used in the write-up. Readers (which can include an examiner) will be on the lookout for clear understanding of recent and relevant literature. The work of authorities in the field and seminal works should feature in the write-up.

Referencing is a means of providing evidence and supporting claims made in the write-up. A researcher cannot simply make a claim or a bold statement and expect the research community to believe it. Instead, the work of others should be used to support claims and statements made in the write-up. This improves the credibility.

A summary of *why* referencing is important from Skillsyouneed.com website:

- Give the original author credit for their own ideas and work
- Validate your arguments, statements and claims
- Enable the reader to follow up on the original work
- Enable the reader to see how dated the information might be
- Prove to the reader a sound understanding of the subject area
- Avoid plagiarism

2. In-text referencing and the reference list

The two major considerations for referencing are *in-text referencing* and the *reference list*.

An *in-text* reference is a citation to an existing work or to a piece of existing work (e.g. chapter in a book). It must include as a minimum the author/s surname, year of publication and page number (if applicable).

A *direct quotation* is a phrase or paragraph or part of the original text which has been repeated verbatim. This is included within quotation marks “ ” followed by author/s surname, year of publication and page number. The researcher should limit the amount of direct quotations in the write-up to less than 10% of total references.

In contrast to a direct quotation, *paraphrasing* is the writing technique of expressing ideas, thoughts or works of another in *your own words*.

A *reference list* is an alphabetical list of works that have been cited. This comes at the end of the write-up but before Appendices. It can contain the details of books, journal articles, conference proceedings, websites or any other sources. The format of the reference list may differ depending on the referencing style or standard.

3. DUT/Harvard referencing style

There are many referencing styles including Harvard, APA and IEEE. DUT uses DUT/Harvard. Please see the library website for a pdf download.

In-text examples:

Single author - According to Mkhize (2021), convolutional neural network algorithm is a popular choice for credit card fraud detection.

Two or three authors - Gama, Singh and Zulu (2018) highlight the shortcomings of UX designs in e-Learning management systems.

Four or more authors – Dlamini et al. (2020) stress the increasing usage of bitcoin in the SME sector.

Direct quotation – “Despite the boom, advances in ICT are seemingly almost always slightly behind developments in cyber-crime” (Garvin, 2019: 21).

Reference list examples:

Mkhize, LMP. 2021. *Credit card fraud detection: a deep learning alternative*. Available: <http://www.aiontheedge.com/article/onlinefraud/mkize21> (accessed 10 January 2021). –

Website

Dlamini, X. M., Martin, A., Naidoo, P. and Pallad, S. 2020. The new currency trends. *ICT for Development and Finance*, 65(5): 166-186. – **Journal article**

Gama, T. Q. P., Singh, V. and Zulu, X. P. 2018. Improving UX for university 4.0: A case study. In: *ICTAS 2018*. Durban, South Africa, 14-16 March 2018. IEEE Computer Society. –

Conference proceeding

Garvin, J. 2019. *The great escape: how Africa is losing to cybercrime*. London. Wiley. – **Book**

Tutorials

1. What is the difference between a citation and bibliography?
2. Download and install EndNote from: <http://library.dut.ac.za/research-support/research-tools/>
3. Download a copy of the DUT/Harvard referencing guide available from the library website. Write out an example of reference list entry for:
 - a. Edited book chapter
 - b. Online book
 - c. Blog and Wiki
 - d. Facebook and twitter message
 - e. Matlab software
 - f. YouTube video
4. What is the meaning of *et al*?
5. Write the correct reference for this lecture note. Use DUT-Harvard style.
6. List three referencing styles except Harvard and DUT-Harvard.
7. Create a simple word document with a paragraph of text. Add three different types of in-text citations using EndNote. Ensure that you set-up EndNote to DUT/Harvard format.

References

Skills you need. 2021. Academic referencing. Available from: <https://www.skillsyouneed.com/learn/academic-referencing.html>. Accessed on: 10 January 2021.

URLs

https://library.leeds.ac.uk/info/1402/referencing/47/referencing_explained.
<https://student.unsw.edu.au/why-referencing-important>